

developers to use. We designed ReDex to be ergonomic from a developer's point of view. We wanted to be able to iterate quickly on ReDex so that we could test and tune our optimisations efficiently," Facebook's Bert Maher said in a post.

Facebook's ReDex removes 'unnecessary interfaces' and strips out metadata that refers to a Java source file in an app. Also, the tool is now designed to organise classes within dex files.

Implementing the new changes, Facebook claims that the start-up time for apps can be reduced from 2 seconds to just 1.6 seconds, resulting in a 20 per cent speed-up.

In addition to improving performance for some high-end devices, ReDex is touted to deliver the greatest benefit for typical Android devices. It offers up to 30 per cent speed-ups on the hardware that most people use to access Facebook.

Facebook has additionally upgraded the existing design of ReDex to make it a useful tool for the masses. You can add it to your existing build toolchain without even adding any supporting scripts. Further, you can use a JSON configuration file to utilise ReDex for optimising apps that are based on the Java Native Interface.

If you are a developer and want to use ReDex to optimise your Android apps, you can find it right on GitHub. Facebook is also asking for your feedback and suggestions to bring about new improvements in the future.

Rackspace now lets you deploy OpenStack on any data centre

Rackspace has announced the open availability of the OpenStack cloud computing platform to let users deploy it on any data centre. The new development will help enterprises and mid-market organisations that want a managed service for their private cloud deployments.

OpenStack was originally designed in 2010 as a joint project between Rackspace Hosting and NASA. Previously, the platform required a native reference architecture to control the processing, storage and networking resources of a data centre. But now, it's open for all, with a simple goal to deliver users an efficient hybrid approach.

"Companies realise they can free up money and resources for more strategic business investments when they turn their IT capital expenses into operating expenses," said Darrin Hanson, GM and VP of OpenStack Private Cloud at Rackspace, in a press statement. "When OpenStack is consumed as a managed service, businesses can remove non-core operations, reduce software licensing and minimise infrastructure acquisition and IT operations costs," he added.

Rackspace is aiming to use OpenStack to increase the adoption of the private cloud in companies. According to company sources, the platform is already providing 99.99 per cent uptime SLA, ensuring its clients have continuous connectivity to their data.

As a result of the new development, you can now deploy Rackspace Private Cloud with OpenStack support on any of your data centres around the world. Rackspace is offering its full services that include end-to-end deployment, and monitoring and operating the required integrated solutions. Besides, Equinix is on board to speed up your experience.

The new announcement emerges just a day after Texas based Rackspace



Toonz gets open sourced

Digital Video, the company that created Toonz, has tied up with Dwango, a Japanese publisher. The two firms recently announced that they have entered into an agreement for Dwango to acquire Toonz.



Toonz is enterprise animation software that was independently developed by Digital Video (Rome, Italy). The software is used by developers for scanning, cleaning up of drawings, editing, animation and compositing. It was also used while making 'Futurama', 'Princess Mononoke' and 'Spirited Away', over the years.

The two companies have decided to seal the deal under the premise that Dwango will be publishing and developing an open source platform based on Toonz (OpenToonz), with effect from March 2016. Moreover, the Toonz Studio Ghibli Version is going to be offered to the animation community as a free download.

OpenToonz includes features that have been developed by Studio Ghibli, which has been a long time user of Toonz. Dwango will be using OpenToonz to create a platform that enables research labs and the animation film industry to work together.

Now, Digital Video is going to shift over to the open source business model and will offer the industry commissioning, installation and configuration, training, support and customisation services. This will allow the animators' community to use state-of-art technology at no cost. The company will also continue to develop and market the Toonz Premium version at a very competitive rate to companies willing to invest in the customisation of Toonz for their own projects.